

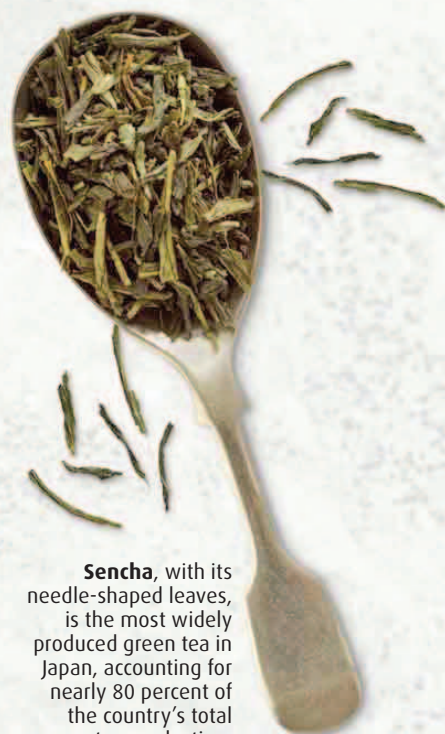
JAPAN

With a tea history that can be traced back to the 12th century, Japan is best known for its green teas. Due to high domestic demand, Japan exports only about 3 percent of its teas.

Tea was first brought to Japan around 805CE by Japanese monks returning from China. However, it was only in the 12th century that the tea plant began to thrive in the Uji area of the Kyoto prefecture. Tea is now mainly grown on two islands, Honshu and Kyushu, with the sea air lending marine and seaweed flavors to the tea. Nearly 75 percent of the tea in Japan is grown using the Yabukita cultivar, which was developed in 1954 in the Shizuoka prefecture. Its leaves have a strong aroma and an

intense flavor. This cultivar provides an abundant growth of leaves, can resist Japan's cool weather, and is suited to the island country's soil.

In Japan, the harvesting and processing of tea leaves are mechanized due to high labor costs. Tall electric fans are a common sight in Japanese tea gardens. These are strategically placed throughout the gardens in order to moderate temperatures, helping to prevent frost in cold spring weather by pushing warm air down toward the tender new growth of the plants.



Sencha, with its needle-shaped leaves, is the most widely produced green tea in Japan, accounting for nearly 80 percent of the country's total tea production.

JAPAN KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE
OF WORLD
PRODUCTION: **1.9%**

MAIN TYPE:
GREEN

FAMOUS FOR: GYOKURO,
SENCHA, GENMAICHA,
MATCHA

ELEVATION:
LOW

HARVEST:
APRIL–OCTOBER



SUWA NO CHAYA TEA HOUSE

This tea house from the Edo period (1603–1868) was moved to its present location in the Imperial Palace grounds in 1912. It is built in the formal and traditional Japanese style.